

KUTUMBA

Family Orientation and Covenant

Welcome, commitments, acknowledgement, and house rules

C1-W1 • What Is KUTUMBA, and Why Are We Here?

V12.2.1 • Families Growing in Krishna Consciousness
Program Director: Swapnil Patil

Internal founding-cohort teaching material — human/temple review EXTERNAL_OPEN

KUTUMBA | Families Growing in Krishna Consciousness

Locked Saturday Schedule

Time	Block
1:50–2:00	Arrival
2:00–2:10	Opening mantras + welcome
2:10–2:30	All-family launch/orientation
2:30–3:10	Parallel tracks
3:10–3:30	Reunification + bhakti laboratory
3:30–3:40	Snack + water
3:40–3:55	Saṅkalpa + Cycle 1 project + home practice
3:55–4:00	Close

TIME CUE	Track handoff is at 2:30; all groups reunite at 3:10.
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Family Orientation

Canonical source: launch/KUTUMBA-C1-FAMILY-ORIENTATION.md • SHA-256:
fdcd022e2defb3d852f841e68c934e6a4ee0308e1c3ad0f29271a9da454394b3

1. Welcome

KUTUMBA is a family-oriented Krishna consciousness formation program. Cycle 1 serves four founding families on Saturday **2:00–4:00 PM**. Parents remain onsite for the entire window. This is **not** a drop-off childcare program, not a substitute temple, and not an initiation or certification pathway.

We gather to protect weekly hearing, practice a small home rhythm, and grow respectful spiritual friendship. We end on time so families can leave peacefully.

2. What KUTUMBA is / is not

KUTUMBA is	KUTUMBA is not
Protected weekly hearing + home practice	Social club only
Parent-onsite shared learning	Drop-off or babysitting
Respectful spiritual friendship	Ranking or public sādhana scoring
Voluntary family commitment	Initiation eligibility track
Age-banded teaching with reunification	Adult lecture while children are unmanaged
Source-checked teaching packets	Speculative theology inventing

3. First six-month map

- Cycle 1 — Identity foundations** (six Saturdays): KUTUMBA purpose; body and self; nature of the soul; human opportunity; temporary vs lasting fulfillment; integration night.
- Cycle 2 — Karma and the modes**: action, responsibility, and material nature (after C1 readiness).
- Cycle 3 — Bhakti**: Kṛṣṇa, guru-sādhū-śāstra, holy name, nine processes.

If Cycle 1 understanding is weak, we **review or extend C1** before starting C2. Speed is not success.

4. Saturday schedule (locked)

Time	Block
1:50–2:00	Arrival / settle

Time	Block
2:00–2:10	Opening mantras / short kīrtana
2:10–2:30	Shared family opening / Prem-kī-Kathā
2:30–3:10	Parallel parent + younger (K–2) + older (Grades 4–5)
3:10–3:30	Family reunification / bhakti lab
3:30–3:40	Child snack + water (**no weekly meal**)
3:40–3:55	Saṅkalpa / project / questions / next week
3:55–4:00	Closing
4:00	End on time

5. Cycle rhythm: six weeks, off week, Utsava

- Six active Saturdays (see [launch/C1-SATURDAY-CALENDAR.md](#)).
- One protected off week for rest and home continuity.
- C1 Utsava / showcase candidate (calendar lists Oct 31, 2026 as candidate only — not confirmed festival).
- Presentations are **non-competitive**. Drawing-only options are allowed.

6. Expectations of participating families

1. Protect the Saturday calendar; communicate absences early.
2. Attempt a 5–15 minute home practice; minimum versions count as success.
3. Keep parents/caregivers onsite during the session.
4. Respect host-home property and common-area rules.
5. Follow child house rules; support the correction ladder without public shame.
6. Avoid gossip, comparison, and publishing private family/child data.
7. Bring questions privately when needed; do not demand speculative answers.

7. Home practice

Usually **5–15 minutes**. A typical week includes:

- memory phrase;
- one verse paraphrase (not a long purport dump);

- one gratitude or service act;
- optional project layer (keep burden low).

If the week is hard: do the **minimum version** written on your saṅkalpa card.

8. Family project — Who Am I, and How Should Our Family Live?

Each week adds a small layer. Week 6 is integration night: ~10 minutes per family to share understanding and application. Rubric dimensions: understanding, application, teamwork, source accuracy. **No ranking.**

9. Rules and correction

See [launch/CHILD-HOUSE-RULES.md](#) and [launch/FAMILY-COVENANT.md](#).

Correction ladder: reminder → redirect → quiet reset → parent involvement → sit out an activity → private conversation. Never yell, shame, force chanting, or compare children.

10. Feedback and privacy

Use the private feedback route named by the owner. Do not post real child names, photos, medical details, or sādhanā scores in shared chats or public repos. Photography/recording is off by default unless explicit host/owner policy says otherwise for a specific moment.

11. Reasonable six-month destination

By the end of the first six months, a reasonable destination is:

- stronger shared vocabulary;
- clearer identity foundations;
- a small sustainable home rhythm;
- age-appropriate explanation of key ideas;
- more respectful speech about bodies and others;
- warmer temple connection where available.

We do **not** promise certification, initiation eligibility, guaranteed advancement, or publication readiness.

12. FAQ

Must both parents attend every week? Aim for whole-family participation. Communicate constraints privately; do not invent attendance penalties.

What if we miss a Saturday? Tell the owner; receive the home-practice card; no public penalty.

Are Gamma slide decks required? No. Production prompts exist; decks are **not rendered** and **not approved**.

Can teachers answer every hard question on the spot? No. The no-speculation rule requires verifying from Śrīla Prabhupāda's books / the source packet.

Is snack a meal? No. Snack + water only; no weekly meal program.

Will my family be ranked? No.

Closing line for families

We protect hearing together, practice a little at home, and grow without comparison.

Family Covenant

Canonical source: launch/FAMILY-COVENANT.md • SHA-256: 21ddaa010c3f2125fa4cd0efa012a9095606edb443a2eabdc8621c64ee8affa6

Scope: Cycle 1 founding cohort — voluntary program commitment **Not:** a legal contract, employment agreement, or temple membership instrument **Privacy:** Do not commit completed signed copies or real family names to Git

Purpose

This covenant helps four founding families and facilitators share clear expectations for Saturday 2:00–4:00 PM KUTUMBA sessions so that hearing, practice, and mutual respect can grow safely.

What KUTUMBA is / is not

Is	Is not
Family sādhana and formation community	Social club or drop-off childcare
Protected weekly hearing + home practice	Substitute for the temple
Parent-onsite shared learning	Initiation pathway or certification program
Respectful spiritual friendship	Gossip, ranking, or public sādhana scoring

Family commitments

By joining Cycle 1, each founding family agrees to:

1. **Protect Saturday 2:00–4:00 PM** as a real calendar commitment.
2. **Aim for whole-family participation** (parents onsite with children).
3. **Communicate absence or lateness** before the session when possible.
4. **Arrive ready to begin** rather than expect a full restart for late arrivals.
5. **Attempt the minimum home practice** each week (usually 5–15 minutes).
6. **Respect host property** and common house rules during the program.
7. **Follow child house rules** and support facilitator redirection.
8. **Avoid gossip, comparison, and public humiliation.**
9. **Give respectful private feedback** rather than side conversations.
10. **Retain primary responsibility** for their own children.
11. **Keep private information private** (no public child ranking; no photography/recording by default without agreement).

12. **Pause or leave respectfully** if the program is not a fit.

Attendance philosophy

Attendance is not a measure of spiritual worth. Unavoidable absence with communication is normal. Repeated patterns of lateness, absence, or non-participation lead to a private support conversation — not a public leaderboard.

Facilitator correction authority

During KUTUMBA time, facilitators may calmly redirect behavior for safety, respect, and learning. Parents remain primary caregivers and support redirection. Host property and safety rules also apply.

Feedback route (private)

Use the template questions: What helped? What confused you? What should we adjust? Any safety/comfort concern? Are you able to commit to the next cycle?

Pause / exit

A family may pause or withdraw with dignity. No public explanation is required. Remaining families continue without commentary.

Acknowledgement

Use [FAMILY-COVENANT-ACKNOWLEDGEMENT-TEMPLATE.md](#) for local paper/print acknowledgement. Do not store completed forms in this public repository.

Blank Covenant Acknowledgement

Canonical source: launch/FAMILY-COVENANT-ACKNOWLEDGEMENT-TEMPLATE.md • SHA-256:
7d11bacbbd4d6ad822e06341ad6ceed969dfbb90ff40476e6fdd9016b47b321e

Instructions: Print locally. Complete by hand. Store privately outside Git. Do **not** commit completed forms.

Field	Entry
Cohort	Cycle 1 founding cohort
Session window	Saturday 2:00–4:00 PM
Family alias (optional, not real name in shared docs)	_____
Number of participating adults	_____
Number of younger children (K–2)	_____
Number of older children (Grades 4–5)	_____

Acknowledgement statements (initial each)

#	Statement	Initials
1	We have read the Family Covenant and understand KUTUMBA is voluntary.	_____
2	We will protect Saturday 2–4 and communicate absences.	_____
3	Parents remain onsite; this is not a drop-off program.	_____
4	We will attempt minimum weekly home practice.	_____
5	We will respect host property and child house rules.	_____
6	We will avoid gossip,	_____

#	Statement	Initials
	comparison, and public ranking.	
7	We will not photograph/record by default without agreement.	_____
8	We understand we may pause or leave respectfully.	_____

Adult signature(s) / date: _____ / _____

Facilitator witness (optional) / date: _____ / _____

Privacy warning: Completed forms contain personal data. Keep offline. Never commit to GitHub.

Child House Rules

Canonical source: launch/CHILD-HOUSE-RULES.md • SHA-256:
6a525f3dd1da740db86e246622696c7b08e28c1f1475227567d639a5bd54ce47

Parents remain onsite. Facilitators guide the session. Host property rules also apply.

Shared rules (all ages)

1. Keep your body safe — feet on the floor; hands gentle.
2. Use respectful speech — no teasing, yelling, or mean labels.
3. Follow the facilitator safety cue immediately (pause / freeze / come here).
4. No jumping on furniture.
5. No indoor throwing.
6. No writing on walls, books, or furniture that are not activity materials.
7. Ask before entering private rooms.
8. Respect belongings — ask before touching what is not yours.
9. Devices away unless the lesson specifically needs them.
10. Snack only in the allowed area; water anytime with permission.
11. Help clean up before leaving.

Correction ladder (no public shame)

1. Calm reminder
2. Redirect / offer a choice
3. Brief quiet reset in a visible space
4. Parent involvement
5. Sit out a specific activity
6. Private parent/program conversation for repeated patterns

Never: public shame, yelling, sarcasm, corporal punishment, forced chanting, or comparing children.

Younger (K–2) emphasis

- Soft voices indoors
- Stay with the group
- Hands to yourself
- Ask before leaving the room

Older (Grades 4–5) emphasis

- Model respectful speech for younger children
- Devices fully away unless assigned

- Help clean-up leadership
- Honest questions welcome; speculation wait for source check

Printable versions: W1 launch-pack [CHILD-RULES-YOUNGER.md](#) and [CHILD-RULES-OLDER.md](#).

RIGHTS NOTE

KUTUMBA-original framing; cited third-party material retains its own rights. Human/temple review remains EXTERNAL_OPEN.